

Profile: Satya Narayana Nadella

Executive Summary

Satya Nadella is the Chairman and Chief Executive Officer of Microsoft, having succeeded Steve Ballmer as CEO in February 2014 and John W. Thompson as Chairman in June 2021. Born in Hyderabad, India, he is credited with steering Microsoft's transformation into a cloud- and AI-first company, overseeing acquisitions such as LinkedIn, GitHub, and Activision Blizzard and growing the company's market capitalization into the trillions of dollars. He is widely recognized for a leadership style centered on empathy and a 'growth mindset' culture.

Basic Details

Full Name	Satya Narayana Nadella
Age / Date of Birth	Born August 19, 1967 (age 58)
Occupation	Chairman and Chief Executive Officer, Microsoft
Industry	Technology / Software / Cloud Computing / Artificial Intelligence
Current City	Bellevue, Washington
Current Country	United States

Biography / Summary

Satya Narayana Nadella was born on August 19, 1967, in Hyderabad, India, to a Telugu Hindu family. His father, Bukkapuram Nadella Yugandhar, was an Indian Administrative Service officer, and his mother, Prabhavati, was a Sanskrit lecturer. He attended Hyderabad Public School, Begumpet, and played cricket on his school team, a formative influence he has said shaped his approach to leadership and teamwork.

Nadella earned a bachelor's degree in electrical engineering from the Manipal Institute of Technology (Mangalore University) in 1988. He then moved to the United States, completing a master's degree in computer science at the University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee in 1990. He later earned an MBA from the University of Chicago Booth School of Business in 1997, and now serves on that university's board of trustees.

He began his career on the technology staff at Sun Microsystems before joining Microsoft in 1992, initially working on the Windows NT operating system. Over more than two decades at Microsoft, he held a series of increasingly senior roles, including vice president of the Microsoft bCentral small-business service, corporate vice president of Microsoft Business Solutions, senior vice president of R&D; for the online services division, and president of Microsoft's Server and Tools business. Immediately before becoming CEO, he was executive vice president of Microsoft's Cloud and Enterprise group, where he led the build-out of the company's Azure cloud platform.

On February 4, 2014, Nadella was named Microsoft's third CEO, following co-founder Bill Gates and Steve Ballmer -- the first CEO in company history who was neither a founder nor an original employee. In 2021 he additionally became Chairman. Under his leadership, Microsoft pivoted from a Windows/Office-centric hardware and licensing model toward cloud computing and, more recently, artificial intelligence, including a major strategic alliance with OpenAI beginning in 2019. He led the company's largest acquisitions, including LinkedIn (\$26.2 billion, 2016), GitHub (\$7.5 billion, 2018), and Activision Blizzard (\$69 billion, 2023). In 2017 he published a memoir, 'Hit Refresh', reflecting on his life, his son's disability, and his approach to reshaping Microsoft's culture around empathy and continuous learning.

Career Timeline

- **1988** — B.Sc./B.Tech in Electrical Engineering, Manipal Institute of Technology (Mangalore University)
- **1990** — M.S. in Computer Science, University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee; joins Sun Microsystems technology staff
- **1992** — Joins Microsoft, working initially on Windows NT
- **1997** — MBA, University of Chicago Booth School of Business
- **1999** — Named Vice President of the Microsoft bCentral small-business service
- **2001** — Becomes Corporate Vice President of Microsoft Business Solutions
- **2007** — Senior Vice President of R&D; for Microsoft's Online Services Division
- **2011-2013** — President of Microsoft's Server and Tools business
- **2013** — Executive Vice President, Microsoft Cloud and Enterprise group
- **February 4, 2014** — Named Chief Executive Officer of Microsoft, succeeding Steve Ballmer
- **2016** — Leads \$26.2 billion acquisition of LinkedIn
- **2017** — Publishes memoir 'Hit Refresh'
- **2018** — Leads \$7.5 billion acquisition of GitHub
- **June 16, 2021** — Appointed Chairman of Microsoft's board, succeeding John W. Thompson
- **2023** — Leads \$69 billion acquisition of Activision Blizzard
- **2024** — Marks 10 years as CEO; Fortune ranks him #3 on its list of Most Powerful People in Business
- **June 2026** — Keynotes Microsoft Build 2026 in San Francisco, framing an industry shift to an 'agent-native stack'; publishes essay warning against AI value concentrating in a few foundation models

Interests

- Cricket (played competitively at school; part of the ownership group of a Major League Cricket franchise alongside Delhi Capitals)
- American and Indian poetry
- Soccer -- part of the ownership group of Seattle Sounders FC (Major League Soccer)
- Reading and writing (authored the memoir 'Hit Refresh')

Network

- Bill Gates -- Microsoft co-founder and predecessor as a defining figure at the company
- Steve Ballmer -- immediate predecessor as Microsoft CEO
- John W. Thompson -- predecessor as Microsoft Chairman
- Sam Altman -- OpenAI CEO; Nadella supported Altman during OpenAI's 2023 leadership crisis and leads Microsoft's strategic partnership with OpenAI
- Anupama Nadella -- wife, whom he met while both studied architecture; part of the Seattle Sounders FC ownership group with him
- Reid Hoffman and Jeff Weiner -- LinkedIn co-founder and former CEO, connected through Microsoft's LinkedIn acquisition

Recent News / Public Activity

- **June 2, 2026** — Delivered the Microsoft Build 2026 keynote in San Francisco, declaring a shift to an 'agent-native stack' and unveiling Microsoft Execution Containers and the Microsoft 'IQ' branding for Foundry, Fabric, and Microsoft 365
- **June 14, 2026** — Published an essay, 'A frontier without an ecosystem is not stable', warning that AI value could concentrate in a small number of foundation models and arguing this is politically unsustainable
- **June 21, 2026** — Gave a Wall Street Journal interview expanding on concerns about concentration of AI value and the need to broaden access and lower costs
- **June 25, 2026** — Announced on X that Microsoft is bringing 'skills' to Copilot for Excel

References / Source Links

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- Microsoft seeks to be AI's center of gravity again - Fortune — <https://fortune.com/2026/06/02/microsoft-moves-to-remain-ais-center-of-gravity/>
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- Microsoft Build 2026: Live updates - Engadget — <https://www.engadget.com/2185601/microsoft-build-2026-live-blog-copilot-windows-news/>
- Satya Nadella (@satyanadella) on X — <https://x.com/satyanadella/status/2070180313654063255>